Stupas



Sanchi near Bhopal, MP

A Stupa is a semi – spherical dome like structure constructed on brick or stone. The Buddha's relics were placed in the centre of the dome.

Monolithic Pillar – Sarnath

The crowning element in this pillar is Dharma chakra.



Monolithic Pillar – Sarnath

Beginning of Rock cut Architecture

Rock – Cut Caves of Barabar and Nagarjuna Hills



Lomas Rishi cave, Barabar

There are several caves to the north of Bodh Gaya. Three caves in Barabar hills have dedicative inscription of Ashoka. And three in Nagarjuna hills have inscriptions of Dasharatha Maurya (grand son of Ashoka).

Reasons for the Decline of the Mauryan Empire

- Ashoka's successors were very weak.
- Continuous revolts in different parts of the empire.
- Invasion by the Bactrian Greeks weakened the empire.
- Last Maurya ruler Brihadratha was killed by his commander Pushyamitra Sungha who established Sungha dynasty.

Ancient name	Its Modern name
Rajagriha	Rajgir
Pataliputra	Patna
Kalinga	Odisha

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